



▲ **A scene from the Liverpool and Manchester Railway** depicting one of the early trains. The success of the railways in Britain drove private investors to invest in railways in India.

The East India Company's (EIC) trade monopoly in India came to an end with the Charter Act of 1833. This opened the doors for British capitalists to seek investment opportunities in the Indian subcontinent. It was a timely move as profit-making industries would help curb the revolting labour forces in England. Also, the export of cotton and coal from India was imperative for the running of the mills in Lancashire and in the industrial markets in Birmingham. Moving the cotton, coal, and other raw materials to ports before being shipped to England needed an efficient transportation system.